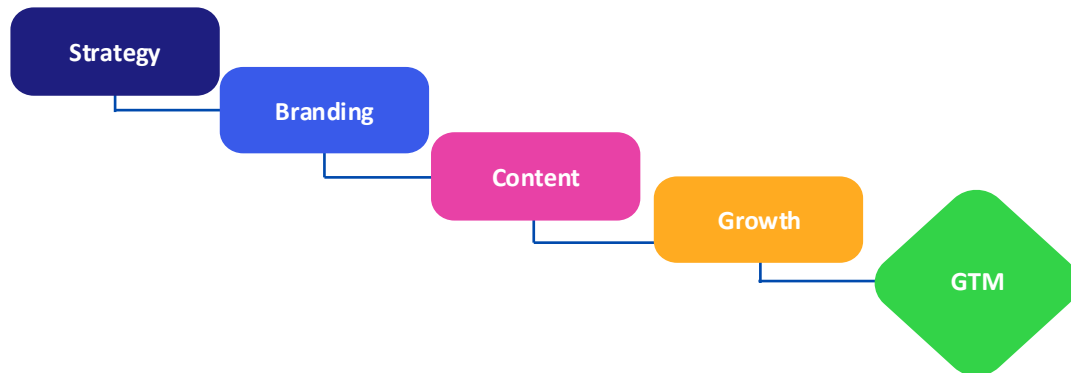




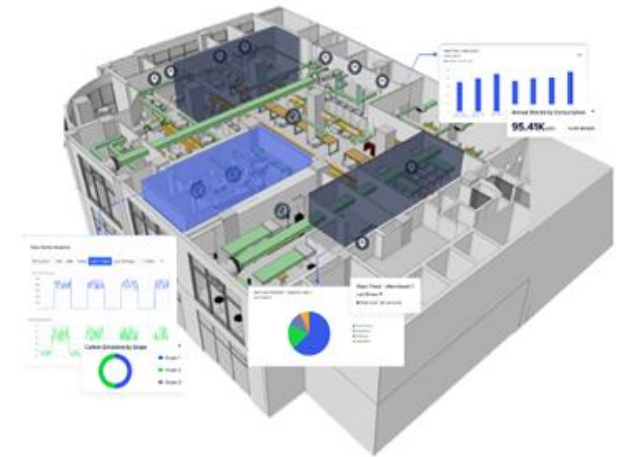
FROM INTERNAL TOOL TO SMART BUILDING PLATFORM

How I helped take Akila from a simple energy dashboard to a branded enterprise smart building platform with measurable pipeline, awareness, and revenue impact as Marketing Lead



Take control of your buildings & portfolio

Akila centralizes data from your assets, operations, and systems for actionable intelligence and AI automation to drive savings & decarbonization.



WHERE IT ALL STARTED

CONTEXT

Akila was founded in 2021 with the vision to transform an in-house machine learning HVAC optimization tool into a comprehensive smart building platform.

The founder saw an opportunity to build something bigger out of the tech by combining it with capabilities from across the organization, including BIM expertise from the AEC business and energy optimization services from the ESCO team. As Marketing Lead, my role was to help translate that vision into a market-ready enterprise platform with a clear brand, positioning, and go-to-market strategy.

What we had

Trademarked
brand name &
logo

Minimum Viable Product:
real-time energy dashboard +
HVAC optimization

Founder vision: A digital twin
platform with a suite of smart
building solutions

What was missing

**Brand identity and
positioning**

**Defined segments,
ICPs, and messaging**

**Demand engine for lead
generation**

The plan

PHASE ONE

Work with leadership, product and commercial teams to identify competitive advantage, prioritizing segments where the product has a market fit

PHASE TWO

Build demand generation and a lead generation machine with clear attribution in alignment with the commercial strategy

BRAND BUILDING: VISION, VOICE, VELOCITY

CONTEXT

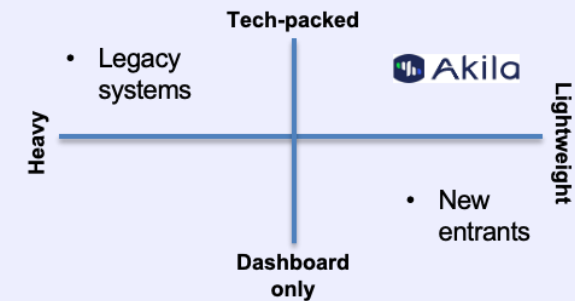
The smart building industry was highly competitive between existing legacy systems and new market entrants. Brand was going to be key for differentiation. The **strategic challenge** was positioning Akila as more than a dashboard, but a highly technically advanced digital twin product.

KEY QUESTIONS

- How to build a unique identity versus legacy brands and new entrants?
- How to represent our product ecosystem and vision through visuals?

Positioning

Lightweight system, with all the technical power of legacy systems.



Visual identity

Dynamic, 3D depth, gradients, and colors inspired by BIM software



Mission/vision

Akila was going to be the go-to partner for decarbonizing buildings

WE BELIEVE NET ZERO IS POSSIBLE

STRATEGIC CONTENT PLAN

- Operating on startup resources required a disciplined approach to content. Every piece was created to either strengthen our market position, support the sales team, or move a target account closer to a buying decision.

LEVEL ONE

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Brand introduction, white papers and thought leadership articles that could be sent directly to key contacts of the commercial team. Partner supported content was also very key here. This was very vision focused – smart buildings, cognitive digital twins, etc.

LEVEL TWO

ACCOUNT-BASED SALES ENABLEMENT CONTENT

Custom content for account-based campaigns. The sales cycle was long, but during that process we gathered intelligence about our target accounts and leveraged that intelligence on customized content that would help drive them to convert.

LEVEL THREE

BUYING COMMITTEE CONTENT

Product content that would satisfy the rest of the buying committee – tech teams, ops teams, purchasing, and sustainability teams – to tell the right story about how our product from the perspective of each function. This content came in the form of web copy, videos, and decks and other sales collateral.

CONTENT LINKS

■ [Example article 1](#)

■ [Example article 2](#)

■ [Example article 3](#)

■ [Brand video](#)

■ [Link to website](#)

PHASE 2: CREATING SCALABLE GROWTH

■ To support product launches at scale, I grew the marketing team from one to five and implemented a structured operating model that aligned messaging, campaign delivery, stakeholder coordination, performance measurement, and sales enablement.

CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ALIGNMENT

Worked with sales, product, and leadership teams to define:

- ICP & segment prioritization
- Product-market fit validation
- Commercial objectives
- Executive stakeholder alignment

MESSAGING FRAMEWORK

Translated technical capabilities into clear value propositions for each ICP:

- Positioning & value proposition
- Brand & product marketing

LAUNCH TOOLKIT

Built the website, content, decks and other collaterals to hit our target audience at each stage of the funnel:

- Website & landing pages
- Sales decks & collateral
- Videos & webinars
- Thought leadership content

CHANNEL ACTIVATION

Supported partner-led campaigns, regional market expansion, and co-marketing with strategic partners including Deloitte and NVIDIA.

- Account-based campaigns
- Partner marketing
- Industry events
- Regional market execution

PERFORMANCE RHYTHM

Created KPI dashboards on Looker to track lead generation, campaign performance, pipeline contribution, and insights for optimization.

- KPI dashboard
- Pipeline visibility
- Campaign optimization
- Continuous feedback loop

■ KEY OUTCOMES

3-4x
increase in
qualified leads

10x
social media
follower growth

\$11M ARR
by end of
2023

■ **THANKS FOR YOUR
CONSIDERATION!**

CONTACT DETAILS

P: +1 615-236-6486

E: jackalmcq@gmail.com